to appear at the French royal court in order to answer for the behavior of Norman sailors who had taken part in a brawl with French ships just off the coast.

When Edward ignored the summons, Philip confiscated Aquitaine as punishment. Edward immediately began to round up allies on the continent. The Duke of Brittany and the Count of Flanders, both hoping to reduce Philip IV's power, agreed to fight with him. He also sent an imperious message to John Balliol, ordering him to send Scottish troops as part of his feudal responsibility to his overlord.

Balliol sent back a meek reply, promising the soldiers; but at this, the aristocrats who had chosen him took the country out of his hands. Twelve of them formed a council to govern the country, and "it was decreed," says the *Chronicle of Lanercost*, "that the king could do no act by himself." Balliol was now no more than a figurehead, earning himself the contemptuous nickname of *Toom Tabard*, "Empty Suit."

On behalf of the country, the Twelve Peers sent to Philip IV, offering to make a treaty with the French against the English. The Treaty of Paris, concluded in 1295, promised alliance with the French throne and hostility to the English. It also began decades of war between Scotland and England: to the English, the Scottish Wars; to the Scots, the Wars of Independence.[11]

Now Edward was faced with the necessity of fighting in both France and Scotland; in France, as a disobedient vassal; in Scotland, as the overlord of a disobedient vassal. Leaving the French war in the hands of his generals, he personally led an army towards the Scottish city of Berwick. At the same time, he sent a navy to assault Balliol by sea. He put Robert Bruce the Sixth, whom he trusted, in charge of the northern fortress Carlisle Castle, on the Scottish border: a key position not far from Hadrian's Wall.

The English army made short work of Berwick. "The town [was] taken," writes the Scottish chronicler John of Fordun, "and all were swept down; and, sparing neither sex nor age, the aforesaid king of England, in his tyrannous rage, bade them put to the sword 7500 souls of both sexes; so that, for two days, streams flowed from the bodies of the slain."[12]

The Scottish defenders were driven steadily back into the north. One by one the castles of Scotland fell: Dunbar, Edinburgh, Stirling. At Montrose, Balliol gave up. He surrendered, coming out of the castle without his royal robes, waving a white wand.

Edward took him prisoner and declared victory over Scotland. On his way back to England, he detoured through Scone Abbey and seized the Stone of Scone. Balliol he imprisoned in the Tower of London; the Stone of Scone he set on the royal coronation seat of England, so that future English kings